



ZAMBIA SOCIAL FORUM

Annual Report

2021



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MESSAGE FROM THE SECRETARIAT

The year 2021 came with many challenges. The anxiety of the general elections, COVID 19 pandemic and not to mention the new strain Omicron virus now ravaging the world affected the operations of Zambia Social Forum (ZAMSOF). Movements had to be limited, programs had to be re-designed and timelines for implementation of activities had to be adjusted to adhere to the new covid-19 health guidelines.

Despite the above scenario, the Zambia Social Forum (ZAMSOF) scored several successes as regards project implementation. The organization successfully implemented activities under the Zambia sustainable small scale fisheries program in Mazabuka and Sinazongwe Districts Promoted and funded by ECO FISH and European Union. Through these activities, small-scale fishers were organized to manage their fisheries resources sustainably.

ZAMSOF also carried out the COVID-19 community response project in five wards of Lusaka which was supported by the German Development Cooperation (GIZ) through the Lusaka Security water Initiative (LUSWI) and Lusaka City Council (LCC).

Through this project, five wards were able to come up with community response plans to address COVID-19 and other health-related challenges in the wards. Furthermore, ZAMSOF also carried out a Covid-19 survey in markets and bus stations.

As a secretariat of the SADC and SAPSN, the organization was instrumental in hosting pre and post coordination and programming of the activities as a road map to the 2021 SADC Peoples summit in Malawi. Most meetings were held hybrid both physical and virtual. ZAMSOF and some stakeholders attended the SADC people's summit hosted by the Republic of Malawi.

The most important event that took place in Zambia was the tripartite elections which saw the UPND forming government. ZAMSOF, together with other organizations was very instrumental in advocating for peace during and after elections based on the principle of a non-partisan line meaning not supporting any single party. These efforts led to peaceful elections, unlike the earlier speculations that violence would be experienced. It is our sincere hope that we will achieve our hopes and dreams for the coming year of 2022.

" Zambia Social Forum (ZAMSOF) scored several successes with regard to project implementation"

S U M M A R Y

Zambia Social Forum (ZAMSOF) is an open space that provides free platform for ordinary citizens to discuss democratically on issues that affect them. The forum aims to formulate affirmative actions that inform advocacy planning and allow citizens to engage at policy level for social change in their respective thematic areas they represent. In Zambia, the National Social Forum concept began in 2003 after Addis Ababa hosted the second edition of the African Social Forum followed by formation of the sub regional foci i.e. Southern African Social Forum (SASF). Since 2003, Zambia Social Forum (ZAMSOF) has been successfully organizing annually National Social forums in towns and communities.

ZAMSOF aims at “improving participation of the general citizenry in the policy making processes for the national sustainable development in partnership with affected communities.” The forum further serves to build community, regional and global solidarity around issues of social, ecological, political, and economic justice in a quest for sustainable development. The forum is an activist platform to strengthen popular democracy and mobilization on various issues and provide human alternatives to the neo-liberal discourse. The open spaces also serve to critically challenge the status quo, which puts markets and profits before people.

V I S I O N / M I S S I O N

Our mission is to activate citizens, community groups and CSOs on a mutually agreed platform cognizant of citizen's right to participate in policy making processes, demand for better life and improved service delivery.

Our vision is a Society without injustices and poverty in which human-kind enjoys its rights to a life between it and the earth

COOPERATING PARTNERS



Promoted and funded by



SAPSN



act:onaid

ZAMSOF STEERING COMMITTEE

SARAH LONGWE - GUARDIAN
REGINA MWANZA - CHAIRPERSON
CONSTANCE NGENDA- SECRETARY
JENNIPHER KABINGA - TREASURER
HENRY KABWE - MEDIA MEMBER
YOUSIAS MBEWE - COMMITTEE MEMBER
FRED MWANSA - COMMITTEE MEMBER
HARRISON MWIMA - COMMITTEE MEMBER
**GERSHOM KABASO JR - NATIONAL
COORDINATOR**

ZAMSOF SECRETARIAT



Gershom Kabaso
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Programs Assistant



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Mobilization/Logistics



Edgar Handulu
Finance Officer



Yousias Mbewe
Office General Assistant

HISTORY

Since inception ZAMSOF has been taking the lead in mobilizing community members to take part in National development processes at both community and National level, Such as development of National development plans, budget planning, engaging with policy makers on issues that affect them in their various communities.

At SADC level from people's perspective ZAMSOF is the mobilizer for ordinary people to take part at SADC people's summit where ever SADC heads of State are meeting.

In regards to the assignment our track record can be traced from Civil Society for Poverty Reduction (CSPR Zambia) Action Aid Zambia, Oxfam Zambia, NGOCC, SAFAIDs, TALC, Activista Zambia, ZIPAR through JCTR Media Network on Child Rights and Development, Zambia Council for Social Development ZCSD, including civic leaders from areas such as Chiyawa Kafue, Chongwe, Chibombo and Lusaka.

OVERVIEW

Zambia Social Forum (ZAMSOF) based on its strategic plan works towards ensuring that people's fundamental freedoms are fulfilled. The organization strongly believes that when the nation has a thriving civic space, people have a strong sense of belonging and actively participate in governance issues and engage with duty bearers to demand for their rights. This greatly reduces social inequalities and corruption. It increases social and economic development of the people. It is in this regard that Zambia Social Forum had partnered with several organizations like ActionAid, LuWSI, PCFS, SAPSN and GIZ in implementing programs that empowered local community members to advocate for their freedoms and also actively take part in governance issues.

The organization also worked closely with Lusaka City Council in de-politicizing and strengthening local structures like Ward Development Committees as part of the decentralization process. As the country's economy continued to deteriorate, ZAMSOF remained focused with its commitment to advocate for citizens social, political and economic rights. ZAMSOF had taken every opportunity to ensure the empowerment of citizens for them to demand their social and economic rights as provided for in the constitution.

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ZAMSOF also carried out the COVID-19 community response project in five wards of Lusaka which was supported by the German Development Cooperation (GIZ) through the Lusaka Security water Initiative (LUSWI) and Lusaka City Council (LCC). Through this project, five wards were able to come up with community response plans to address COVID-19 and other health-related challenges in the wards.

73K

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During the times of COVID - 19 pandemic, social media was used complementary to many of the activities implemented. Platforms such as radio, television, webinars, Facebook, Twitter, virtual meetings were used and were able to reach over seventy three thousand two hundred and thirteen people

112

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Throughout the year, over a hundred and twelve meetings and trainings in fish farming value addition, awareness raising and capacity building. These impacted over hundred people and brought about change in their respective communities.

365

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By December 2021, we had a total of three hundred and sixty core members including CSOs, NGOs and Community groupings across Zambia who form Zambia Social Forum (ZAMSOF).

SUSTAINABLE SMALL SCALE FISHERIES PROGRAM

ZAMSoF is implementing a project titled "Zambia Sustainable Small-Scale Fisheries Project (ZSSFP)" implemented in partnership with Keepers Zambia Foundation (KZF) and ActionAid with the support from the ECOFISH and European Commission. It contributes to SDG 1 on ending poverty through enhancing their access to fisheries resources which is key to bringing them out of poverty, SDG 5 on gender equality as women have not only equal representation in all activities but also leadership building, and access to security of tenure and SDG 14 on conserving and sustainably using oceans, seas and marine resources for sustainable development through focus on sustainable fisheries management through eradicating destructive fishing practices e.g. harmful chemical for fish capture. The overall objective of the project is to enhance the social, economic and environmental sustainable management of small-scale fisheries in Zambia. The aim of the project is to "strengthen small-scale fisheries management and governance in three provinces of Zambia (Southern, Western and Lusaka) to protect livelihoods, build resilience of small-scale fishing communities thereby contributing to SDGs. ZAMSoF is spearheading activities in Southern province (Mazabuka and Sinazongwe districts). The following were the activities implemented in 2021:

- Selection, Formation/Strengthening of Ten (10) community level village fisheries committees in each district. Each of these committees to be comprised of ten (10) members inclusive of women and youths.
- Identified two (2) leaders from each 20 Village Management Committees
- Leadership building training for 40 identified leaders was conducted
- Trained 125 VMC members in sustainable management of fisheries
- Trained 125 VMC members in integrated fishing and farming
- Trained 60 fishers on access to and Control over fisheries
- Trained 60 community volunteers in advocacy and fisheries policy
- Trained 60 VMC members in value addition

SAPSN - SOUTHERN AFRICAN MARKET CAMPAIGN

SAPSN is a membership-based network of national movements and community-based initiatives working on debt, trade, structural adjustment, poverty and globalization in the SADC region. Its work is to coordinate and support pro-poor grassroots based collective actions and people's struggles against all forms of injustices, inequality and exclusion in Southern Africa. SAPSN sought the support of four Country Focal Points either Institutions or Individuals to facilitate country level initiatives of the Southern African Markets. These initiatives broadly comprise the coordination of campaign, convening, awareness raising and policy influencing activities pertinent to the realisation of overall project objectives. ZAMSoF is the country focal point for SAPSN in Zambia. The objective of the SAF Markets Campaign was to promote markets access and influence government and its cooperating partners to increase rural participation through quality investment in the farming sector to enhance their capacity to meet market requirements in terms of quality and quantity. The overall aim of the assignment was to coordinate country level initiatives of the Southern Africa Markets Campaign. The project was implemented in the following districts: Chama, Mufulira, Isoka, Mongu, Mansa, Chinsali, Kafue, Mpika, Chongwe, Chipata, Kapiri Mposhi, Choma, Mumbwa, Chingola, Petauke and Lusaka. Participation was done virtually and participants were supported in terms of data. The following activities were done in 2021:

- Consolidated research, stakeholder perspectives and regional frameworks to formulate a locally relevant campaign strategy to advance to the aims and objectives of the Campaign
- Engaged active Oxfam, FANAPAN and SAPSN Partners to ensure their inclusion and buy-in of critical allies.
- Supported the development of in-country Campaign knowledge products and messaging (Markets Campaign Reader; Weekly Twitter messages & hashtag; Community Voices Videos; public polls/surveys; WhatsApp posters and video adverts)
- Convened in-country Markets Campaign/Stakeholder Forum Meetings
- Facilitated regular networking and interactions amongst key stakeholders using digital tools
- Supported mobilisation for Regional Campaign Launch process
- Contributed at least one publishable article; country Statement and on Markets
- Facilitated one Media briefing to raise awareness on the campaign
- Contributed to the report on country activities for Project Report

APSN

Southern African People's
Solidarity Network



SAPSN Vision:

envisioning economic,
political, social and political
justice in Southern Africa

SAPSN Mission:

the social, economic and
justice in Southern Africa
mobilizing citizens
and voice to demand and
alternative pro-poor social
economic policies that
reducing poverty, inequalities
and injustices"

WHO WE ARE:

is a glue binding social
together for social and
justice in the SADC Region

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SAPSN - COORDINATION OF CSO STRUCTURES & INCOUNTRY PROGRAMMATIC ACTIVITIES

In 2021, SAPSN (through ZAMSoF as the focal point) catalysed and supported, people-driven collective responses to the pressing challenges of the COVID Pandemic; Regional Food Insecurity; Debt Crisis, Climate injustice and Militarisation in Zambia. Ongoing national and thematic level interventions of SAPSN are guided by the agreed positions detailed in the 2020 SADC Summit Declaration underpin thus ensuring shared impact and cohesion across countries and themes. However, strengthened coordination and capacitation of national focal persons and Institutions is critical in order to accelerate, deepen and synergise these initiatives.

ZAMSoF, as the focal point for SAPSN, is responsible for national level coordination, mobilisation, advocacy and conscientisation processes in advancement of the shared goals and objectives of SAPSN in Zambia. The 2021 Annual Plan of SAPSN gave guidance and direction to the work of SAPSN in 2021. Central to the Annual Plan was the 2021 SADC People's Summit that was held in Lilongwe in August 2021. National and thematic level initiatives building up to the Lilongwe Summit gave critical momentum and credibility to mobilisation and consultative processes that were aimed at building a critical and representative mass for the Summit. The following activities were done in 2021:

- Ensured representation of National structure in Quarterly Regional Coordinating Committee (RCC) Meetings and attend RCC Strategic Planning Meeting (August 2021)
- Coordinated country representation and present country updates during regular virtual SAPSN Regional Assemblies.
- Coordinated pre-SADC Summit country engagement and development of country
- Coordinated and mobilized country delegation to Lilongwe SADC Summit Advocacy and Campaigns
- Coordinated monthly updates, articles and relevant awareness raising materials for amplification on SAPSN social media pages and publications
- Coordinated country level Campaign, and Advocacy activities for regional campaign processes
- Contributed to national and regional level networking and stakeholder engagement processes including regular engagements with National SADC Desks, SADC Parliamentary Forum and other relevant bodies.
- Contributed to the development, fundraising and implementation of a proposed Regional capacity strengthening programmes for social movements and CSOs

COVID-19 COMMUNITY RESILIENCE AND RECOVERY PROJECT

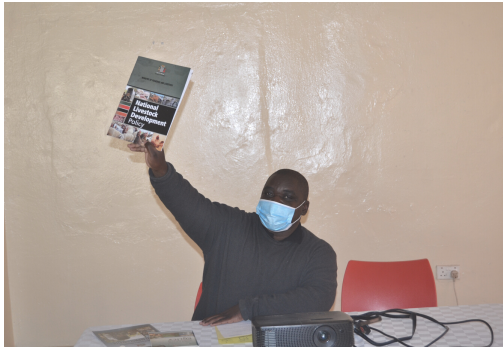
LuWSI's response to the pandemic since May 2020, has been coordinating partners to implement activities that aim to promote and strengthen the response to Covid-19 prevention in communities, markets, bus stations, and schools. Through the Lusaka City Council, LuWSI undertook activities and measures in 5 selected wards of Lusaka to build adaptive capacities for the communities against COVID 19 including pilot development of C19 community response plans with financial and technical support from LuWSI and its partners, thereby contributing to community resilience during and post COVID 19 pandemics. The five wards of Lusaka district were; Kamulanga Ward, Lima Ward, Mwembeshi Ward, Silwizya Ward and Kanyama Ward 10. ZAMSoF's role was to support LCC, local governance structures and other stakeholders collaborate and demonstrate the value of community leadership throughout the process and implementation of the activities. In addition, ZAMSoF provided an oversight on the implementation from the perspective of quality control and quality assurance including; document exactly how each of the tasks is accomplished by the mandated institutions and the right holders. The following activities were done in line with the project:

- Organized orientation Meeting with Councilors, WDCs Members and local structures in Kamulanga, Lima, Mwembeshi, Kanyama Ward 10 and Silwizya Wards
- Conducted WDCs Training in Emergency Preparedness, Response and Management for COVID-19 and other epidemics
- Facilitated community resource identification and Mapping meetings
- Conducted Rapid Vulnerability Assessment Exercises
- Supported the development of Radio and Television sensitization programs
- Conducted mobile community sensitizations on COVID-19
- Finalized of COVID-19 response plan and submitted of the final report and all the project related products



2021 GALLERY

A look at some of the activities that have been carried out in the course of the year



Next Steps

Going forward Zambia Social Forum seeks to strengthen already existing programs that promote social and economic development of the people.

The organization will also use its networks and take advantage of its position as the SADC focal point for civil society organization to ensure that the state fulfills its obligation of guaranteeing fundamental freedoms of association, Assembly , expression) and also to create platforms through which citizens engage in public policy making. It is in this regard that the organization will seek more partnerships with like minded organizations to advocate for a thriving civic and political space.



01

Strengthening democratic governance

The organization will also use its networks and take advantage of its position as the SADC focal point for civil society organization to ensure that the state fulfills its obligation of guaranteeing fundamental freedoms .



02

Service delivery

This will be done by providing materials that assist with project implementation for example fishing nets for fishers, and increased access to knowledge



03

Conduct lobbying and mobilization of the new crop of activists

ZAMSOF will also conduct lobbying and mobilization of the new crop of activists especially the youths around issues strengthening the social movement processes.



04

Local and International Partnerships

It is in this regard that the organization will seek more partnerships with like minded organizations to advocate for a thriving civic and political space.

Acknowledgements

Zambia Social Forum wishes to extend their earnest gratitude and appreciation for the support provided by the Cooperating partners, secretariat and the board as well as the following partners

MISHECK KUMWENDA - FREELANCE MEDIA
HENRY KABWE - MEDIA LIAISON
MULELA KUMWENDA - FACILITATOR
MARTIN NKHOMA - FACILITATOR/ARTIST
JIMMY SIMUKOKO - ARTIST
HARRISON MWIMA - PROGRAMS
KATONGO BWALYA - FARMER REP
DR GILBERT SIAME-UNZA TECHNICAL SUPPORT
MS NAMASIKU MUYOBA - DOCUMENTATION
MS LUYANDO MWEENE - DOCUMENTATION
MR KESHI CHISAMBI - ZANABURA CONFERENCING
MIGA WILFRED -PELUM ZAMBIA TECHNICAL SUPPORT
MALAMA KASALWE - GIZ CONSULTANT
BRENDAH MPHANDE - CONSULTANT
COLLINS MUNTANGA - CONSULTANT
GOODBYE CHINYAMA - INDEPENDENT CONSULTANT
MERCY NAMUTOWE - LEAD DATA ENTRY
DANIEL THOLE - CHAMA DISTRICT FOCAL POINT
CHARLES MULILA -DECOP FACILITATOR

****The list is non exhaustive**

Acknowledgements

We also express our Gratitude and appreciation in relation to the provision of Conference Hall for ZAMSOF Meetings to Non –Governmental Gender Organization Coordinator Council (NGOCC) and Zambia Library Cultural Skill Centre for Visually Impaired (ZLCSCVI). The courtesy also extends to the following corporate & community partners

SIGHTSAVERS ZAMBIA, ZAMBIA NATIONAL ASSOCIATION OF THE BLIND IN RURAL AND URBAN AREAS (ZANABURA) CHAMA DISTRICT DEVELOPMENT WOMEN ASSOCIATION, KALABO-TEACHERS RESPONSE AGAINST CHILD ABUSE (TRACA), ISOKA WOMEN ASSOCIATION, LUNDAZI DISTRICT WOMEN ASSOCIATION, CHIPANGALI DISTRICT WOMEN ASSOCIATION, ACTION GOVERNANCE FOUNDATION, CIVIL SOCIETY FOR POVERTY REDUCTION (CSPR), CUTS ZAMBIA, ZAMBIA NATIONAL EDUCATION COALITION (ZANEC), KAFUE MANNA WIDOWS, TREATMENT ADVOCACY AND LITERACY CAMPAIGN (TALC), OASIS ENVIRONMENT HEALTH WATCH (OASIS), MEDIA NETWORK ON CHILD AND DEVELOPMENT (MNCRD), SAVE THE GIRLS (STG), ARTS IN BUSINESS SOCIETY, DEVELOPMENT EDUCATION COMMUNITY PROJECT (DECOP), ACTIVISTA ZAMBIA.

****The list is non exhaustive**



We thank the local and international community for your continued support in our efforts to contribute to the success of our plans and activities and ultimately the developmeent of Zambia.

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